



HCF AND SECURITY STAFF GUIDE

Safe ward support and security checks

A practical SecureObs guide for healthcare support staff and security staff using observations, enhanced support, security checks, safety escalation and tasks.

Sign in and confirm ward context
Support observations and enhanced observation cover
Record security checks and count variances
Raise safety incidents and patient tasks
Escalate clearly to nurse in charge

Secure Obs

High secure ward observation workflow

Real

Security checks

Ash Ward | Ash Nurse

History

Back to observations

Checkpoint status

Cutlery checks

Per meal | Count required

No check recorded

Due

Level 1 patient checks

Weekly + ad hoc | Visual check

No check recorded

Due

Level 1 / room / locker / zone checks

Per shift | Visual check

No check recorded

Due

Ward security checks

Per alert | Visual check

No check recorded

Due

Record check

Cutlery checks

This area needs a counted total.

Cutlery count

Notes expected 0

12

Items expected 0

12

Spoons expected 0

12

Notes

Complete

Save security check

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1. What this route covers

Role purpose This route supports safe ward operations. HCF and security staff may help record observations, security checks, incidents and tasks, but clinical escalation remains with the nurse in charge or responsible clinician.	
Area	Guidance
HCF focus	Observation support, patient location/presentation updates, enhanced observation support, tasks and escalation.
Security focus	Security checks, count variances, searches/checkpoints where configured, safety incidents and escalation.
Always escalate	Any immediate risk, uncertainty, safeguarding issue, medication concern or clinical deterioration must be escalated to nursing/clinical staff.

2. Start of shift

1	Sign in Use NFC staff card or STAFFCODE/PIN. Temporary staff should check the allocation start and end time shown in the current session. If access fails, ask the nurse in charge or manager to check the record.
2	Confirm context Check the selected site, ward and staff name before recording anything.
3	Review ward overview Look for overdue checks, active incidents, patient tasks and sync issues.
4	Know your allocation Confirm which patients, observation levels, security checks or tasks you are responsible for.
5	Escalate uncertainty If you are unsure whether you should record something, speak to the nurse in charge first.

3. Observation support

Action	Support staff guidance
Patient identity	Check name, room and hospital number before saving any record.
Location	Record where the patient is actually seen using the location labels configured for that ward.
Presentation	Record awake or asleep accurately.
Notes	Keep notes brief and factual. Escalate clinical concerns instead of writing long clinical interpretation.

Enhanced observations	If assigned, record location/presentation and follow the plan of care and observation level exactly.
Late checks	The record becomes late at the due time. During the first five minutes a reason is not mandatory; after five minutes, record the real reason and inform the nurse in charge if checks are repeatedly late or unsafe.
NFC or QR verification	Where enabled, scan the correct room or personal tag and confirm direct visual observation. A room tag does not prove the patient was present.

Secure Obs

High secure ward observation workflow

33 sync issue

Ash Ward

SecureObs Super Admin | Intermittent every 60m

Change staff or ward

General observations

NEWS2

Enhanced/ TESO

Patient settings

Patient management

Previous obs

Security checks

Medication chart

Staff rota

Time

25 Jun 21:20:05

Shift 2 | 15:00-23:00

Nurse in charge
Alex Nurse

Medication nurse
Jamie Night Nurse, Alex Nurse

Ash Ward patients

SecureObs Super Admin | Rooms

Rooms

Ending soonest

On Enhanced observations

1

John Doe

Nhs-bm1234

Last 21:19 | Side room | Awake

By SecureObs Super Admin

NEWS2 - No score
Not recorded

Intermittent

Due in 59m

4

Jordan White

RH220120

Last 21:19 | Day room | Awake

By SecureObs Super Admin

NEWS2 - Score 0
24 Jun 21:00

Eyesight

Due in 60m

7

Taylor Brown

NH100421

Last 21:16 | Side room | Awake

By SecureObs Super Admin

NEWS2 - Score 2
25 Jun 16:34

Eyesight

Due in 56m

11

Casey Black

NH100677

Last 21:19 | Side room | Asleep

By SecureObs Super Admin

NEWS2 - Score 3
24 Jun 13:57

Intermittent

Due in 60m

General observations: select the correct patient, location and presentation.

4. Security checks

1	Open Security checks Use the security checks screen when the ward has this module enabled and you are assigned to complete checks.
2	Choose checkpoint Select the correct area or patient-specific check from the checkpoint list.
3	Enter counts accurately For cutlery or item-based checks, enter actual counts for every required item.

4

Record variances

If counts do not match expected values, save the variance and escalate according to local process.

5

Use history

Review history to check what has already been recorded for the day or shift.

6

Never hide uncertainty

If a count is unclear, record the facts and escalate rather than guessing.

Count variance rule

A count variance should be treated as a safety issue. Record what was counted, preserve the audit trail and tell the nurse in charge or security lead.

Secure Obs
High secure ward observation workflow

Ready

Security checks
Posidien Ward | SecureObs Super Admin

History Back to observations

Checkpoint status

Cutlery checks
Per meal | Count required
Cutlery: knives 12/12, forks 12/12, spoons 8/8 | Complete by SecureObs Super Admin at 16:42 360m

Level 1 patient checks
Weekly + ad hoc | Visual check
Patient: Room 1 Harrison Jackson (SP-221335) | Reason: Leaving ward | Complete by Graham Gardiner at 07:58 9556m

Locker, Level 1
Monthly | Visual check
Patient: Room 2 Dean McDonald (Sp-11132) | Complete by Graham Gardiner at 14:23 43061m

Matress checks
Monthly | Visual check
Patient: Room 2 Dean McDonald (Sp-11132) | Complete by Graham Gardiner at 14:23 43061m

Room / locker / level1
Monthly | Visual check
Complete by Graham Gardiner at 07:58 42676m

Ward security checks
Per shift | Visual check
Complete by Graham Gardiner at 07:58 Due

Record check
Ward security checks
Record the check outcome.

Checklist

Todo	Radios	Expected 1	1
Todo	Cameras	Expected 1	1
Todo	Razors	Expected 1	1
Todo	Toothbrushes	Expected 1	1

Completion 0%

Notes
Complete, issue found, action taken...

Save security check

Security checks: checkpoint status, recording and history.

5. Safety incidents and patient tasks

Area	How to record
Safety incident	Use for injury, fall, violence/aggression, self-harm, safeguarding, security or other significant concern.
Severity	Use RAG rating honestly: red for immediate/serious risk, amber for review, green for monitor.

Body map	Select affected areas for injury or physical concern where relevant.
Immediate action	Record first aid, area made safe, staff informed, nurse called or other immediate action.
Patient account	Record the patient's own words where possible, or why this could not be obtained.
Patient task	Use tasks for follow-up actions, but urgent risks must still be escalated verbally.

6. What not to do

- Do not use another staff member's login.
- Do not record an observation if you did not complete or witness it.
- Do not guess counts, locations or patient presentation.
- Do not resolve incidents or tasks unless you are authorised and the action has genuinely been completed.
- Do not use SecureObs as a replacement for emergency escalation, safeguarding policy or nurse-in-charge review.

7. End of shift and handover awareness

End-of-shift item	Expected action
Before leaving	Check that assigned observations, security checks and tasks are completed or handed over.
Sync badge	If pending items remain, tell the nurse in charge and follow local sync process.
Temporary access warning	When the five-minute expiry warning appears, save unfinished work and prepare to hand over. The session ends automatically at the allocation end time.
Handover notes	Give factual verbal handover for anything that needs immediate awareness.
Active incidents	Do not leave active safety concerns without clear ownership.

8. Troubleshooting

Issue	What to do
Cannot sign in	Check STAFFCODE/PIN or NFC tag. Ask nurse in charge/manager to confirm active status and ward access.
Security area missing	The ward may not have the check configured or enabled. Escalate to manager/security lead.
Patient missing	Confirm selected ward and ask nursing staff to check patient setup.
Sync issue appears	Open sync status if trained to do so, read which item is waiting and retry only after authorised sign-in. Otherwise tell the nurse in charge before leaving the tablet.

Unsure if clinical

Stop and escalate. Do not record clinical interpretation beyond your role.